



New Release
Firefox 3.5 RC is set to
release in June 2009



Moblin 2.0 Beta
Intel releases a new beta version
of Moblin – it's an OS for netbooks
and MIDs



Portable drives let you carry your
data; with portable virtualisation
tools, your OS can go along!

Virtually Portable

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For many, virtualisation might be nothing more than jargon. It automatically relates to something to do with servers and businesses. It is much more than that. It's handy for everybody. It could be a school going student or a businessman, and everyone in between. With compact storage, users were able to carry large amounts of data on drives.

Carrying data is just a part of the entire problem. Being able to carry pre-installed applications would make it

more useful. Some people would even like to carry their operating system with them. Carrying an operating system means carrying all the applications, your data and customisations with you. Portable storage is affordable and devices such as flash drives have shrunk in size. There are flash drives today that are one-third the size of your wristwatch.

Some development groups and companies have tried addressing this issue. PortableApps (www.portableapps.com) is one such free bundle of software specifically for flash drive and

portable hard drive users. The applications in this package can be run straight from the flash drive without having to install them. Similar to the PortableApps pack, U3 is a company that specialises in making applications for portable drives. If you've owned flash drives that has bundled software in it, you would've heard of U3. If you have a U3 drive, there's a free application called U3 PackageFactory that lets you create your own portable applications for it.

One of the software specifically made for carrying applications around is called Mojopac. Different from U3 and PortableApps, Mojopac runs as a layer on top of your existing operating system. Mojopac's basic version is free for download on its site – www.mojopac.com. The commercial version costs around Rs. 2,500 (\$49.99) for a single user license. This version has additional security features to protect your portable OS from the primary OS, some antivirus features and also a built-in PDF printer.

Mojopac is sensitive to service packs. A 32-bit Windows XP on SP2 or SP3 is the most stable operating system to run Mojopac on at the moment. Mojopac can install on a flash drive, a portable drive or even on your iPod.

Installing Mojopac

Everything that you install on Windows will go straight into a separate folder structure, so there is hardly any direct interaction with the Windows registry or folders on your current operating system.

The first step of installing Mojopac is installing it. The installation need not be done on the local drive, but on the portable drive that you'll be carrying around with you. We'll be using this same installation to access Mojopac on every system. This means, there's no need to install a separate client version of Mojopac on every system to access the data on the drive. The second step of the installation requires you to choose the drive you want to install Mojopac.

Running Mojopac

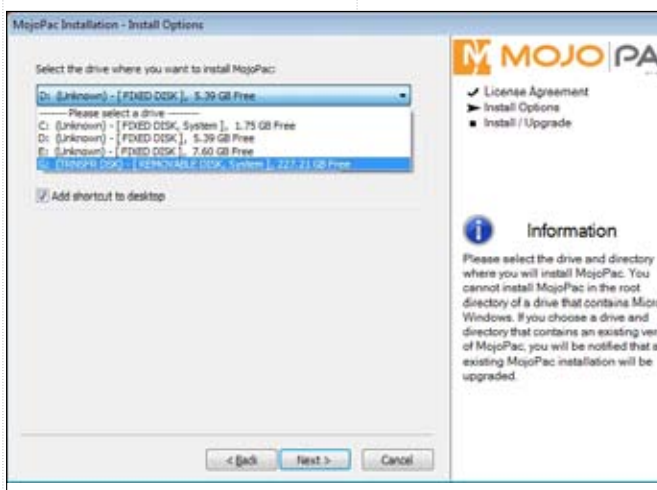
Mojopac sets itself up to autorun when you connect the flash drive or hard drive to the PC. When it runs, you'll be shown a desktop like the one after a clean install of Windows. There are no installed applications in this interface.

You should be able to access the internet, download and install applications the same way you would on a regular desktop. All this data is directly written to your flash drive and not your local one.

The interface of Mojopac is really simple to understand. There is a banner on top which lets you access some of its functions.



PackageFactory for U3



Selecting the install drive for Mojopac